

MVP BUILD PROPOSAL

Advance Deposit Tracker

A lightweight web application to manage supplier advance deposits, payment processing, and overdue-shipment analytics — delivered as a working MVP.

01 Understanding the Requirement

You need an internal application that controls how advance deposits are sent to overseas suppliers, processes those payments through the Accounts team, and surfaces analytics on overdue shipments — replacing the spreadsheet-driven process you run today.

We have reviewed both inputs you shared: the **Process Document** (roles, workflow, status lifecycle, access control) and the **live tracker workbook**. From that workbook we are treating the **first sheet — the deposit submission data — as the single source of truth** for the application's transactional model. It gave us the exact fields and the computed analytics the application must reproduce, so the app mirrors the way your team already works, with the controls the process document specifies layered on top. Master and reference data, including the vendor list, is supplied to us separately and integrated as lookups.

What the application must do

CONTROL

Gate deposits

Block requests to defaulted suppliers; enforce role-based access via company Gmail login.

WORKFLOW

Submit → Pay → Lock

Merchandiser raises a request, Accounts processes payment, the record locks once confirmed.

INSIGHT

Overdue analytics

Read-only metrics on overdue days, lead time, and cost of fund, filterable across the book.

Grounded in your process document

The build follows your process document directly — the master lists, the Merchandiser → Accounts → Analytics flow, the defaulted-supplier gate, the status lifecycle, and the access-control rules are all implemented as specified. On top of that base we add the super-admin layer and central dashboard you asked for.

The headline commitment: a working, deployed MVP covering the full happy-path workflow and every role in the access hierarchy by **Monday, 22 June**. The sections that follow set out how the application is architected, exactly what is included in the MVP, and what is deferred to a later phase.

02 Proposed Solution & Architecture

A lightweight, full-stack **Next.js** web application — fast to build, fast to load, and simple to host and maintain — with the workbook's structure migrated into a proper relational database.

FRAMEWORK
Next.js (App Router)
Single full-stack codebase — UI and server logic together. Fast to ship and easy to extend in later phases.

AUTHENTICATION
Google Sign-In
Company Gmail login (Auth.js), restricted to approved emails with roles assigned across the access hierarchy.

DATABASE
Postgres
Masters and submissions become proper tables. Computed metrics run as reliable server-side calculations.

HOSTING
Vercel
One-click deploys, secure HTTPS URL, zero server maintenance — ideal for an MVP and for live review.

Roles & access hierarchy

● **Super Admin** Central Control Tower — every view, all records, global settings and default-flag approvals

Merchandising

- **Merchant Admin — manages the team**
- Raise a new deposit request
- Defaulted-supplier block + disclaimer
- Withdraw / cancel before payment
- Own dashboard + read-only analytics

Accounts

- **Accounts Admin — manages the team**
- Pending payments, oldest first
- Enter payment (bank, date, status)
- Mark processed → record locks
- Own queue + read-only analytics

Analytics

- Read-only, available to all roles
- Overdue days & cost of fund
- Day-delta / lead-time metrics
- Filter: vertical, customer, staff, date
- No edits permitted

Each team self-manages through its own admin, while the Super Admin sits above both with the central dashboard (see section 05).

Status lifecycle (as specified)

STATUS	SET BY	MEANING
Pending Payment	System (on submit)	Awaiting Accounts action
Hold by Merchandiser	Merchandiser	Submission paused
Hold by Accounts	Accounts	Payment review pending
Payment Processed	Accounts	Record locked, payment confirmed
Canceled by Merchandiser	Merchandiser	Withdrawn before payment

03 MVP Scope — Delivered by Monday

The MVP delivers the complete end-to-end workflow with every role in the hierarchy and all the controls in the process document. It is a usable application, not a prototype — seeded with your existing data so the team can work in it from day one.

CAPABILITY	INCLUDED IN MVP
Google login & roles	Sign-in with company Gmail; access by approved email, with the role assigned across the hierarchy — Super Admin, Accounts Admin, Merchant Admin, and team operators.
Reference data	Suppliers/vendors, defaulted suppliers, customers, verticals and team members — supplied separately and used to drive every dropdown and the defaulted-supplier gate.
Merchandiser flow	Own-requests dashboard, new-request form with master-driven dropdowns, defaulted-supplier block with disclaimer, submit, and withdraw/cancel before payment.
Accounts flow	Pending-payments queue (oldest first), request review, payment entry, and "Payment Processed" lock that freezes the record.
Analytics view	Read-only metrics — ETD (grace) overdue days, payment-to-ship, payment-to-request, actual ETD overdue, cost-of-fund flag — with filters by vertical, customer, staff and date.
Dashboards	Overdue exposure summaries (by delay bucket, customer, vertical, merchandiser) mirroring the workbook's analytics tabs.
Data migration	One-time import of existing deposit requests from the first sheet of the workbook, cleaned on the way in. Reference data is integrated separately.

Also included — expanded scope

Beyond the core workflow, the following are now part of the delivery (previously flagged for a later phase):

Super-Admin Control Tower Central cross-team dashboard — capital, exposure and accountability in one view (section 05).	Overdue-recovery workflow Structured follow-up and escalation once a paid shipment runs late.	Finance approval flow In-app workflow to set and clear defaulted-supplier flags.
Supplier-default feedback Auto-surfacing chronically-late suppliers for the defaulted list.	Full audit history Per-user, field-level change log across each record's life.	FX & advanced exports Optional currency conversion and scheduled report exports.

Out of scope — Phase 2

Only one item remains deferred, and it does not block daily use of the MVP: **notifications** — email/WhatsApp alerts to Accounts and Merchandisers — which follow in Phase 2.

04 Data Model — Workbook to Application

The application is built around the **first sheet of the workbook — the deposit submission data**, which we treat as the single source of truth for transactional records. Reference and master data is supplied separately and linked in as lookups.

SOURCE	APP ENTITY	ROLE
Deposit submission sheet (first sheet)	Deposit Requests	Core transactional record — single source of truth from this workbook
Derived from submission data	Computed views	Overdue metrics & dashboards
Supplied separately	Reference / master data	Suppliers, defaulted suppliers, customers, verticals, team members

The deposit request — field ownership

MERCHANDISER ENTERS

Request date · Supplier · Supplier & Sunshine invoice no. · Customer · Currency · Deposit amount & % · Vertical · Total proforma amount · Estimated shipment date · Estimated ETD · Remarks

ACCOUNTS ENTERS

Payment date · Bank · Payment status · Ship date · Accounts remarks · (system stamps updated-by and timestamp)

SYSTEM COMPUTES (READ-ONLY)

Grace ETD (estimated ETD + 10 days) · ETD-grace overdue days · Payment-to-ship days · Payment-to-request days · Actual ETD overdue days · Cost-of-fund applicability · Default status · Delay range / bucket

One input we'll need from you: the exact **cost-of-fund** calculation rule and the annualised rate behind it. The submission sheet stores the resulting figure but not the formula — confirming this lets us reproduce it precisely.

05 Super-Admin Control Tower

A central dashboard for the Super Admin — a single, cross-team view that brings together the read-only analytics your process document defines, so the whole pipeline can be overseen from one place.

What the Super Admin sees

The Control Tower consolidates, across both Merchandising and Accounts, the analytics the process document specifies — presented as one live overview rather than separate per-user views.

THE ANALYTICS, IN ONE PLACE

ETD (grace) overdue days · payment-to-ship · payment-to-request · actual ETD overdue · cost-of-fund applicability — the five metrics from your document, aggregated across both teams.

FILTER & OVERSEE

The same filters the document calls for — vertical, customer, staff and date range — alongside overdue-exposure summaries and a view of the longest-pending items.

One source, scoped by role

SUPER ADMIN

Oversees everything across both teams; holds global settings and defaulted-supplier approvals.

TEAM ADMINS

The Accounts Admin and Merchant Admin each see and manage their own team only.

OPERATORS

Merchandisers and Accounts staff see their own records, exactly as the access-control rules specify.

The dashboard reads from the same single source of truth as every other view — there is no separate data. Each role sees the slice its access level allows, with the Super Admin seeing the whole.